Listing 3.16 A basic outline of a web page containing content that will be repeated

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
    <title></title>
    <link rel="stylesheet" href="~/lib/bootstrap/dist/css/bootstrap.min.css"
    ➥ />
</head>
<body>
    <div class="container">
        <header class="card alert-success border-5 p-3 mt-3">Header</header>
        <nav class="card alert-primary border-5 p-3 mt-2">Navigation</nav>
        <div class="row mt-2">
            <div class="col-3">
                <div class="card alert-warning p-5 border-5">
                    Deal Of The Day Widget 1
                </div>
            </div>
            <div class="col-9 card border-5">
                Main Content
            </div>
        </div>
        <footer class="card border-5 p-3 mt-2">Footer</footer>
    </div>
</body>
</html>
```

If you created multiple pages that included this common content in each page separately, the burden of maintaining it would likely become intolerable. Every time you added a new page to the site, you would have to update the navigation in all the existing pages. Ideally, you want to centralize these pieces of repeating content in one location to be easy to maintain. This approach is known as *DRY* (don't repeat yourself). DRY is one of the essential principles in software development.

Layout pages enable a DRY approach to managing common page content. They act as a parent or master template for all content pages that reference it. You have already looked briefly at the layout page in the sample application when you added your new page to the site navigation. A layout is a regular Razor file with a .cshtml extension, but what makes it act as a layout is that it contains a call to the `RenderBody` method, where the page-specific content is rendered, as shown in the following listing.